

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

Financial wellbeing is, I believe, the missing piece in the self-care puzzle. Accepting, acknowledging and understanding the role of money in all other areas of our lives is absolutely essential to living well – because money dictates so much of our lives to us, and has so much power over the way that we feel. It needs to be noted, too, that you don't have to be experiencing financial difficulty to want a better relationship with money. Even if you're earning enough to keep up with possibly toxic spending habits, or you're just about managing to get by, financial stress can keep you awake at night and play a part in feelings of discontent or low self-worth. It can cause arguments and ill-feeling, and make you feel resentful and envious – all of which are totally normal things to experience, but exhausting when they are constant or recurrent, especially if they are avoidable.

As with most things, because we are all individuals, with different priorities, circumstances, goals and experiences, each person is likely to have a slightly – or even wildly – different definition of financial wellbeing, and different ideas about what it would take for them to achieve it. What I value will inevitably be different from what you value, and we'll have different aims and aspirations for our lives, meaning that our ideas about what will make us feel fulfilled and content will be different too.

We also exist as part of a system, and care and wellbeing are systemic and collective responsibilities, as well as individual ones. So, making sure that we view our relationship with